

duolingo brand

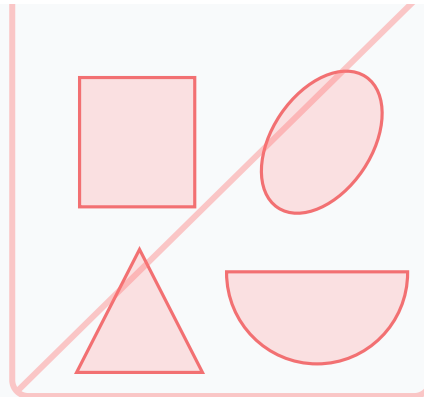
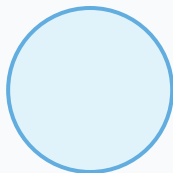
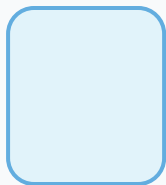
ILLUSTRATION

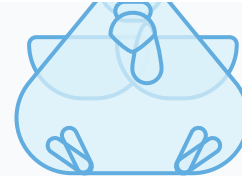
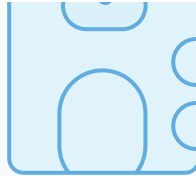
shape language

You know a Duolingo illustration when you see one. That's because we follow a few simple guidelines, from the color palette to our use of shadows. Follow along to create illustrations that fit into the Duolingo world.

**Construction** 

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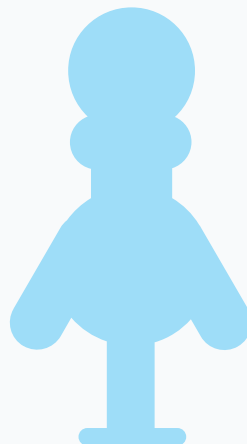


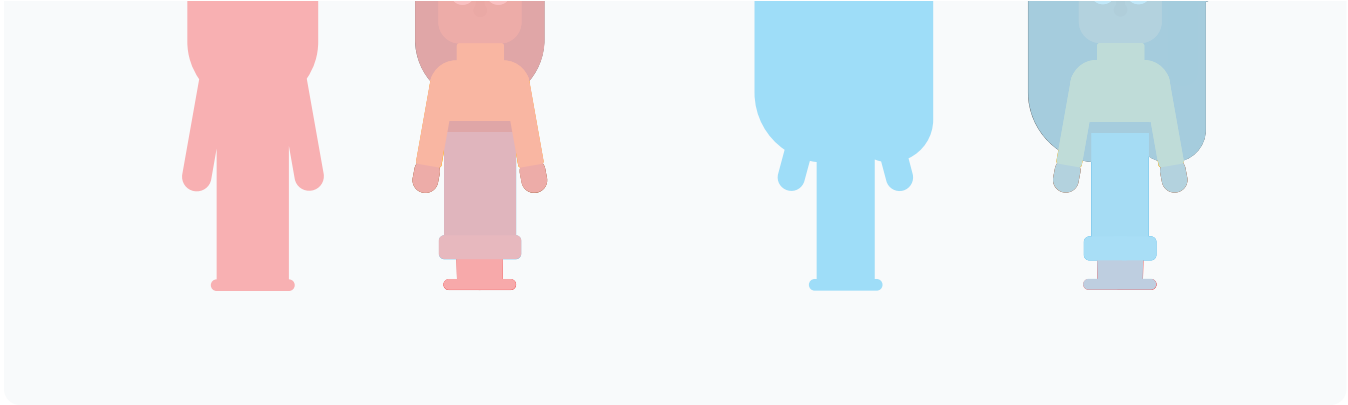


All of our illustrations are made from three basic shapes: the rounded rectangle, the circle, and the rounded triangle. You'll probably find yourself using the rounded rectangle the most. It's okay to use your pathfinder tool to cut shapes up as you need them. Just make sure that every shape has rounded edges. Pointy shapes are off-brand.

Rhythm

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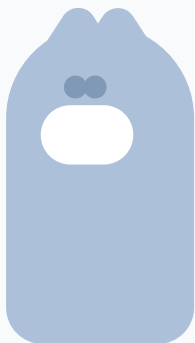
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It's the rhythm of simple shapes that makes our illustrations interesting. Imagine each illustration is a melody. No one wants to hear the same note played over and over, but if you switch between longer and shorter notes, the ear gets interested. Take a look at the reddish blocks on the left: Shapes with similar visual weight are predictable and uninteresting, while a variation in shapes gives the eye something exciting to look at. We want to create a character that, beyond being visually pleasing, actually communicates a story through their design. Rhythm helps with that.

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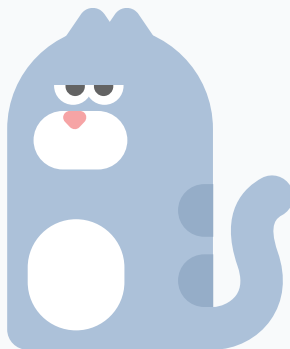


Simplicity



6 shapes

Not enough shapes, too
abstract



15 shapes

Good!



30 shapes

Too many shapes

shape matter in the illustration. Stylistically and practically, we need to use the fewest shapes possible.

Objects In Space



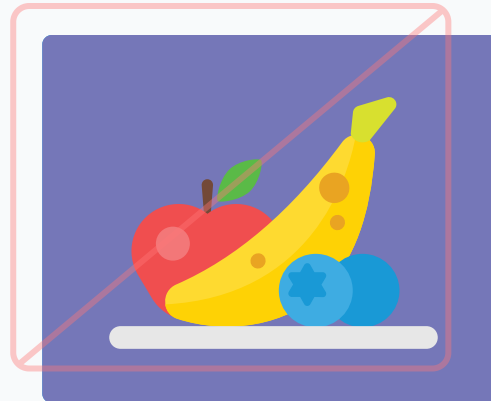
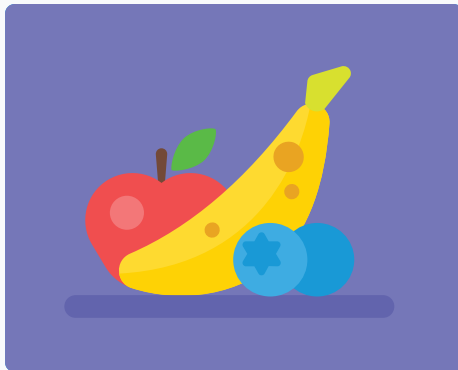
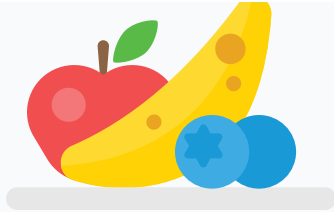
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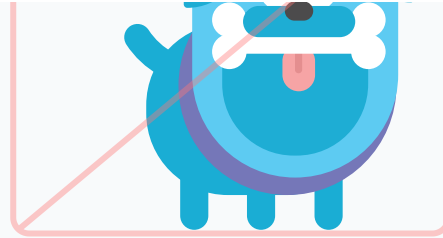
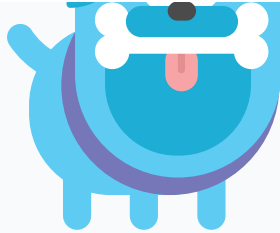
Duolingo characters and icons are designed on a flat perspective. Depth can still be conveyed as long as it's on the same line of sight.

OBJECTS IN SPACE

Shadows And Shading

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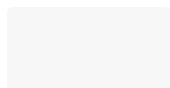
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Shadows always appear below characters and objects as a pill shape — never an oval, because ovals imply perspective.

The shadow's color depends on the background. Never put a shadow under an illustration that isn't a darker color than the base it's sitting on.

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Color

**Polar**

F7F7F7

**Swan**

E5E5E5

**Hare**

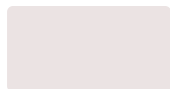
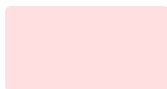
AFAFAF

**Wolf**

777777

**Eel**

4B4B4B

**Squid****Walking
Fish****Flamingo****Pig****Crab**

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**Cardinal**

FF4B4B

**Fire Ant**

EA2B2B

**Canary**

FFF5D3

**Duck**

FBE56D

**Bee**

FFC800

**Lion**

FFB100

**Fox**

FF9600

**Cheetah**

FFCE8E

**Monkey**

E5A259

**Camel**

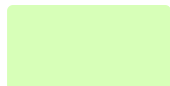
E7A601

**Guinea Pig**

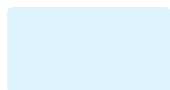
CD7900

**Grizzly**

A56644



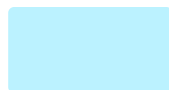
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**Iguana**

DDF4FF

**Anchovy**

D2E4E8

**Beluga**

BBF2FF

**Moon Jelly**

7AF0F2

**Blue Jay**

84D8FF

**Macaw**

1CB0F6

**Whale**

1899D6

**Humpback**

2B70C9

**Narwhal**

1453A3

**Starfish**

FFAADE

**Beetle**

CE82FF

**Betta**

9069CD

**Butterfly**

6F4EA1



COLOR

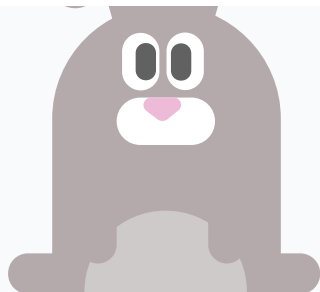
Assigning Color



This is fine



This is better

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This is fine



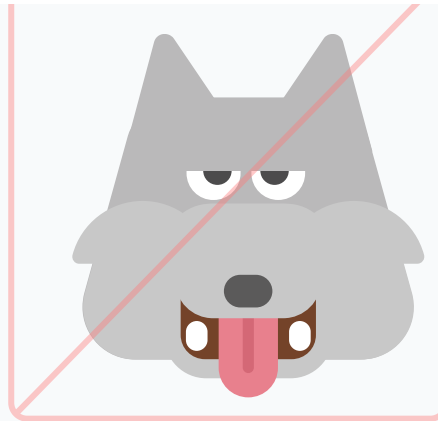
This is better

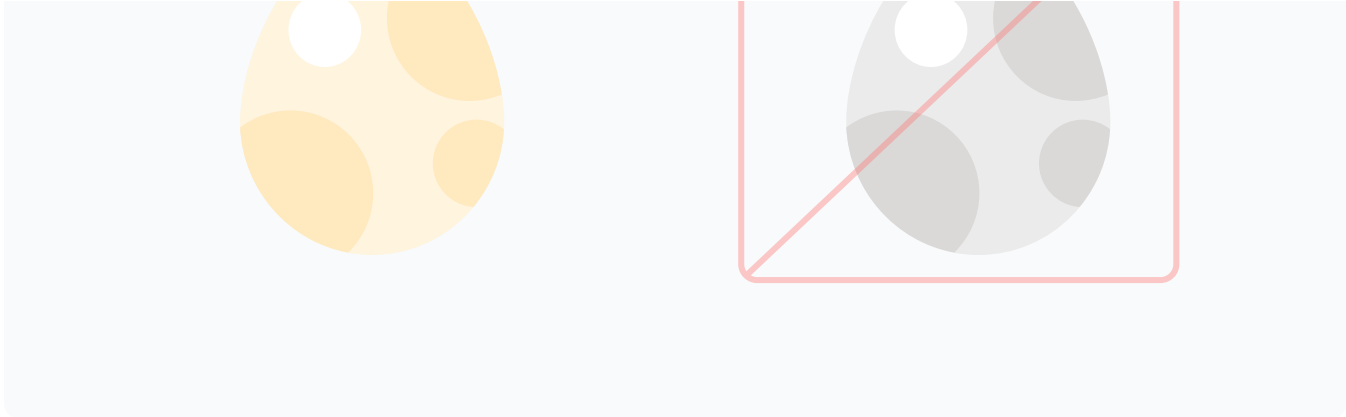
Be as playful as you'd like. We want our illustrations to be colorful and vibrant.

COLOR

Pastels Vs. Gray

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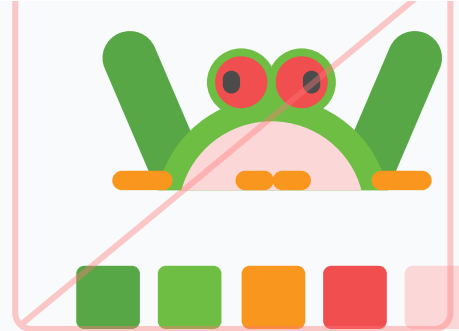




All of our apps and services are designed with white backgrounds. This prevents us from using white as a base color. Instead, use the light pastels in our palette. But never use gray — it appears lifeless and cold compared to the rest of our bright palette.

COLOR

Too Much Color

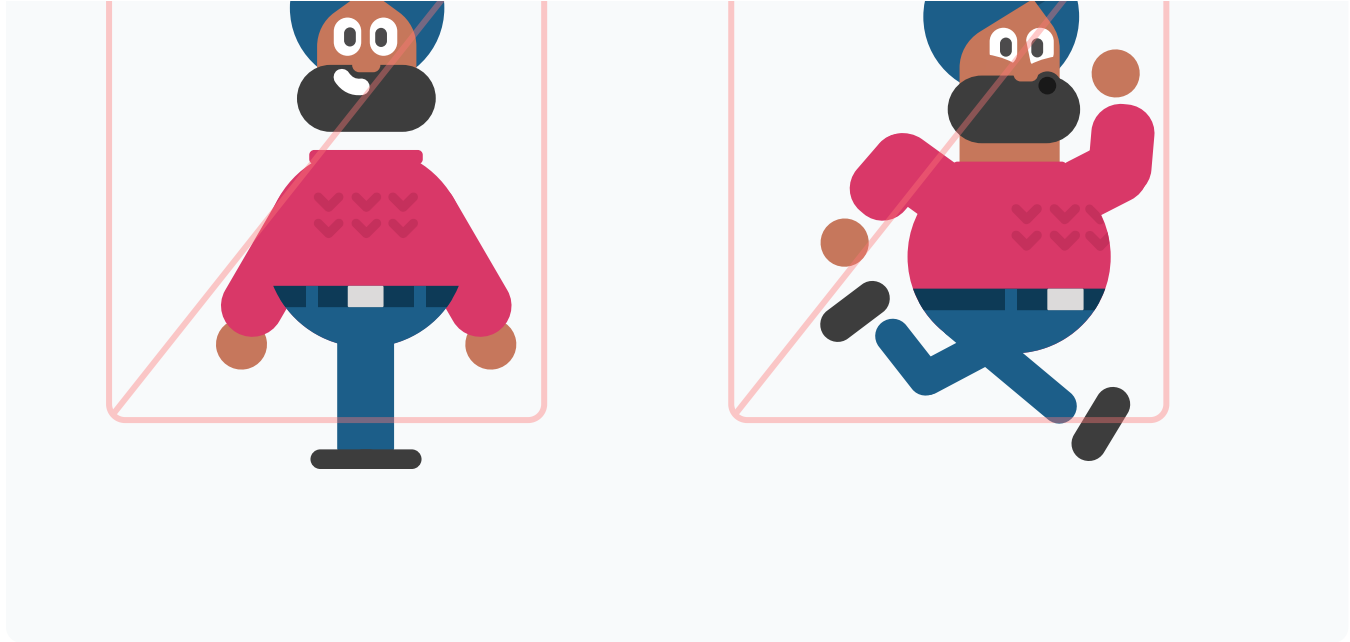
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Keep your illustration to a few colors. Too many colors can hurt legibility when an object scales to a small size.

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We'll occasionally have certain objects float above or below a character or object. We take this design element from Duo's feet, which kind of flutter below his body as he jumps and flies. Floating objects

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< Glossary

Characters >

